



DIONYSIA

— FOUNDING CREATOR PACK —

For Alex.

— PREPARED, BY HAND, ON THE EVENING OF MAY 14, 2026 —

Alex — your line earlier today, "I need to see your website before committing," is the move every serious cinema person should make before signing onto anything new. It is the reason this pack is in front of you tonight rather than a fortnight from now. The fact that you said it directly — instead of disappearing into vague enthusiasm — is itself a signal of the standard you bring.

Your reply after, "Yes, perfect. Looking forward to it Kanish," is the door you opened, not the door you walked through. What follows is the long-form version of what you've been added to. Not so you commit before May 24 — but so when the platform opens that night and you see, firsthand, what is actually being built, you'll already know exactly what it is, what it asks, what it does not, and where you would stand inside it. Decide then, with full context.

Until then, this is yours to read at your own pace. Write back with anything that lands wrong, anything missing, anything you'd change. The room is being built with you, not at you.

I. WELCOME

DIONYSIA is not another upload feed and it is not a curated showcase that pretends to be a platform. It is the beginning of a permanent institution: a global home for serious cinema made in a new medium, built to outlast a hundred trend cycles and to scale, deliberately, into one of the cultural surfaces this medium will be defined by.

The first chapter is being built with a founding circle of filmmakers whose craft long predates the current AI moment — people who have already built studios, schools, careers, and bodies of work, and who can tell the difference between a generated frame and a directed one. You are being invited into that circle. Not as an early user of a product, and not as a name on a launch list. As one of the architects of the institution itself, if you decide on May 24 that this is the place where you want your work.

Your arc maps onto the exact shape of what this founding circle is being assembled around. A Super 8 in your hands at twelve, and the lesson — that the camera was running while the film had already ended — that turned passion into discipline before most filmmakers learn there's a difference. A Master's in Cinema Production, three decades of broadcast craft, and now founding the AI Filmmakers Directory from New York — the connective tissue of an entire emerging community. You don't read like a take on the future of cinema. You read like one of the few people in it who knows the fundamentals well enough to be trusted with the new medium.

Everything DIONYSIA will mean in five years gets shaped by the work this founding circle puts on the wall in this first chapter — and by the standard you, collectively, decide is the standard. The point of this document isn't to ask you to agree with every word. It's to make sure you know exactly what you would be joining, before you join it.

II. THE FOUNDING CHARTER

Every platform pretends to have values. Most discover them under pressure and rewrite them quietly. DIONYSIA's charter is fixed, in writing, before the doors open. It is the rail every editorial, product, and infrastructure decision will pass through — at this size, and at every size after.

— WE BELIEVE —

- *that AI is a medium, the way 16mm or DV is a medium — not a subject, not a genre, and never the noun in our sentences.*
- *that the films are directed, not summoned. A tool can render a frame. Only a filmmaker can intend one.*
- *that emotional resonance is the only criterion that matters. Audiences will always forgive imperfect images. They never forgive emotional disconnection.*
- *that a serious work deserves to land in a place where serious people will actually watch it — credits, breath, silence, and all.*
- *that curation is care, not gatekeeping. A "no" with a reason is more respectful than an algorithm's indifference.*
- *that the filmmakers who built the first chapter should be honored as such — economically, editorially, and culturally — for as long as the platform exists.*

— WE REJECT —

- *the contextual collapse of feeds — where a year of work shares a scroll with an "animals dancing" clip and authorship quietly disappears.*
- *the slot machine of unmoderated upload, the cynicism of "creator-owned" as marketing copy without real ownership, and any phrase that uses the word "content" to describe a film.*
- *open submissions without an editorial wall. Submission is not publication.*
- *algorithmic for-you feeds, where popularity becomes a substitute for taste and curation disappears into noise. Discovery on DIONYSIA stays editorially intentional — at this catalog size, and at every size after.*

— any framing — internal or external — that treats founding filmmakers as a stepping stone, a stage, or an audience to be replaced. You are not the rollout. You are the institution.

III. YOUR ROLE

The honest version of what would be asked of you — and, just as importantly, of what would not.

— WHAT WE ASK —

1. **ONE FILM, OR MORE, WHEN READY.**

If you decide on May 24 that this is the place, we are inviting you to bring the work you'd want it to be defined by. That can be a single film, a small curated set from across three decades of cinema and broadcast production, or recent work made with the new medium — whatever shape best represents what you want a founding-circle filmmaker of DIONYSIA to be known for. We are not chasing volume. We are honoring the standard you set.

2. **PRODUCTION NOTES, WRITTEN BY YOU.**

A short director's statement for each film — what the film is, what it was trying to be, what the tools were, where the hand was, where the machine was. This is not marketing copy. It is the record that lets a viewer take your work seriously.

3. **YOUR NAME ON THE FOUNDING WALL.**

A public credit as a founding filmmaker of DIONYSIA, with the right to revoke it at any time. The wall is the most visible asset in the platform's first year, and it belongs to the people who built the first chapter — permanently, regardless of where DIONYSIA goes after.

4. **PRESENCE, ON TWO NIGHTS.**

The Founding Filmmakers night — gated, private, peer-to-peer — and a single public premiere window in the weeks after, where you appear in the live room with viewers for thirty to forty-five minutes. Both are detailed in Section V.

5. **HONESTY, IN PRIVATE.**

Tell us what is broken. Tell us what is missing. Tell us when the editorial framing is wrong about your work. The founding circle is a peerage, not a customer base — and the only way the platform stays serious as it scales is if the people who built the first chapter speak honestly to the person running it.

— WHAT WE DO NOT ASK —

1. **NO COMMITMENT BEFORE MAY 24.**

Nothing in this document obligates you to deliver a film, accept the founding-circle credit, or appear on either night. The pack exists so that when you see the platform firsthand on the first night, you'll already know exactly what saying yes would mean. The decision lives entirely with you, and it's made then — not now.

2. **NO EXCLUSIVITY REQUIRED.**

At this stage, no exclusivity is asked of you, on any film. You can keep distributing wherever you already do — your YouTube channel, the Directory, broadcast, anywhere. As the platform matures, opt-in premiere-window agreements with clear, transparent terms will be introduced — never as a default condition, and never tied to founding-circle status. The regulations that govern licensing, windowing, and rights will be written carefully and shared in writing before they take effect.

3. **NO VOLUME TARGETS, NO UPLOAD CADENCE.**

We will never ask you to ship faster. The founding circle exists in the opposite direction from those incentives. If you bring one film or you bring several, both are welcomed on the terms you set.

4. **NO MARKETING LABOR.**

You are not a growth channel for the platform. We will not ask you to repost, cross-promote, tag, or perform on social. If you choose to share through the Directory or your own channels, that is yours.

5. NO SILENCE IN EXCHANGE.

If at any point this stops being a place you want your work in, you tell us, we lift the films, and you leave with everything you came with. The door swings both ways, at every size the platform reaches.

IV. SUBMISSION SPECIFICATIONS

The platform runs on a premium video pipeline (Mux), the same infrastructure used by MasterClass, Patreon, and HBO Max. The specs below will read as familiar — they are, deliberately, the language a broadcast professional with a Master's in Cinema Production already speaks.

- **MASTER FORMAT** ProRes 422 HQ, DNxHR HQ, or high-bitrate H.264 / H.265 .mp4. Any broadcast-quality master is fine; we transcode from there.
- **RESOLUTION** 1920×1080 minimum; 3840×2160 (4K) preferred where it exists. Vertical orientations supported but framed for letterbox display by default.
- **FRAME RATE** Native to your project — 23.976, 24, 25, or 29.97 fps. Do not conform unnecessarily.
- **AUDIO** Stereo or 5.1, 48 kHz, -14 LUFS integrated target (broadcast-streaming standard). Loudness pass strongly preferred; we can normalize if needed.
- **RUNTIME** No upper or lower bound. Shorts (under 15 minutes), features, episodic — the editorial frame adapts. We resist the dogma that any one runtime is "right" for the medium.
- **POSTER** A title-card still at 800×1200 (vertical) plus a 1920×1080 hero frame. If you don't have a poster, we'll cut one from the film with you.
- **CAPTIONS** .vtt or .srt in English. Machine-generated draft is fine; your final approval.
- **PROVENANCE** Tools used, hand-authored layers, AI-generated layers, and — if any synthesized likeness appears — performer-consent attestation. Part of the public film record. A moat, not a footnote.
- **DELIVERY** Direct link to a private cloud transfer (Frame.io, Dropbox, Google Drive, WeTransfer Pro). No public file hosts. Receipt confirmed in writing inside twenty-four hours.

These specifications are the current pipeline. The platform's video, audio, and rendering quality will continue to improve with every update — and masters delivered into the founding library automatically inherit every upgrade after. The standard floor will only rise. Yours rises with it.

If any of this is a problem — format, gear, anything from your studio side — write back. The specs are a target, not a wall.

V. THE TWO NIGHTS

The first chapter has two scheduled moments. Both are deliberately curated. The first is the one you've already been added to. The second is conditional on the decision you make after the first.

— THE FIRST NIGHT —

Founding Filmmakers, Sunday, May 24, 2026.

Private, gated, peer-only. The platform opens for the first time, with the founding filmmakers and the founder in the room. Magic-link sign-in, allowlist-only — no public URL works, no link forwards, no spillover. This is the moment you and Kanish discussed: the one where you see, firsthand, what is actually being built, instead of a teaser version of it.

No press, no metrics, no audience-facing spectacle. The point of the first night is that the people who built the institution — and the people being invited into the founding circle — are the first to see it standing up. Your decision about whether to bring work into this chapter lives entirely on the other side of that evening.

DIONYSIA First Light, June 8–10, 2026 (one evening, date confirmed by June 1).

On the evening of June 8–10, we'll open the doors a little wider — for one night only. Film experts, curators, fellow artists, and the people you'd want in the room are invited to a live premiere of the founding work. You'll be the host, not the visitor. More on that closer to the date.

Live comment surface (Discord, Telegram, or Substack — locked by June 1). One founding film unveiled in full. The filmmaker present in the live room for thirty to forty-five minutes after the credits roll. Format borrowed from MUBI's "Film of the Night" and the indie album-release listening party, sharpened for cinema.

Your role on the second night, if you choose it, is not to perform. It is to be in the room while serious people watch your work for the first time, and to answer the questions that follow with the same care you put into making it.

And the recording window you and Kanish discussed earlier — that gets locked in on your timeline, after the May 24 reveal, once you've seen what the platform actually is. No date, no commitment, before then.

VI. A DIRECT LINE

There is no support queue. There is no founding-creator portal. There is one person running this, and that person is reachable.

For anything substantive — the recording window, the editorial framing of your work, the second-night logistics, a doubt about the institution, an idea that should change the platform, a question about anything on these pages — write to kanishtuteja@gmail.com directly. Replies inside twenty-four hours, usually faster.

The platform itself lives at dionysia.ca. Until May 24 it shows a single opening surface — the one you've already seen. On the first night, the room behind it opens, and your allowlisted email gets you in.

If something is wrong, say it directly. You already did once today, and it earned you this pack. The founding circle is small enough — and serious enough — that there is no professional reason to soften the signal. You're not a customer. You're a peer being asked to evaluate a peerage before deciding to join it.

VII. CLOSING

The cultural surfaces that defined the last century of cinema — the studios, the festivals, the houses — all began with a founding circle of artists who took the work seriously before anyone was watching.

DIONYSIA is being built to be one of those surfaces for the medium that comes next: to be everywhere this work deserves to be seen, on every screen it deserves to live on, for as long as cinema is made this way. If you decide on May 24 that this is the place, the institution begins with you in it.

The reel is hand-set, frame by frame. Thank you for the standard you brought to the conversation today.

— ONE LAST WORD, JUST FOR YOU —

Alex, the arc from a twelve-year-old in front of a Super 8 — running out of film, learning the difference between passion and fundamentals — to a Master's in Cinema Production, three decades of broadcast craft, and founding the Directory that maps an entire emerging community, is the exact through-line DIONYSIA is built to honor. A filmmaker who already understands that the camera always tells you what was missed only after the fact, and who built the infrastructure for the next generation to find each other faster than that first reel found you.

Your own line says it better than any pitch could: *"The technology evolves, but human connection through story never goes out of style."* That is, almost word for word, the editorial criterion this place is being built around. New York is one of the places this medium's first chapter has to run through. Having you evaluate the founding circle from inside — not as a name on a list, but as someone whose standard was already *see-it-first-then-decide* — is exactly the kind of seriousness this room needs in it.

On May 24, the platform opens. You'll see, firsthand, what is actually being built — not a teaser version of it. Decide then. Whatever the work you would want this place to be defined by — bring it. Whatever needs to flex around your calendar, the Directory, the recording — say it. The room is being built with that conversation already in mind.

See you on the first night.

— Kanish

FOUNDER, DIONYSIA
DIONYSIA.CA